25901809

MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM

MGU-UGP (HONOURS) REGULAR EXAMINATION APRIL 2026

SECOND SEMESTER

Discipline Specific Core Course (DSC) - MG2DSCTXL100 – TRADITIONAL EMBROIDERED AND WOVEN TEXTILES OF INDIA

(2024 ADMISSION ONWARDS)

Duration: 1 Hour 30 Minutes **Maximum Marks: 50**

Remember(K), Understand(U), Apply(A), Analyse(An), Evaluate(E), Create(C), Skill(S), Interest(I) and Appreciation(Ap)

Students should attempt at least one question from each course outcome to enhance their overall outcome attainability.

Part A

Multiple Choice Questions

Answer all questions

Each question carries 1 marks

1.Find out the stitch that is not coming under the outline stitches category. [K] / [CO1]

b). **French knot**

2. Name the weaving technique that creates multicolored designs in the traditional kani shawl [K] / [CO2]

c). **Twill-tapestry weaving**

3.which of the following Northern embroidered textile of India is known for its luluxurious metal embroidery? [K] / [CO3]

c). **Zardosi**

4.Muslin is made from which type of fabric? [K] / [CO2]

c). **cotton**

5. What does the colour 'zingari' refers to in Kashmiri embroidery? [K] / [CO3]

b). **Green**

6. Identify the centre where Amru was produced . [K] / [CO2]

d). **Ahmedabad**

7. Find the embroidery in the central region of India, which migrated from Persi [K] / [CO3]

c). **parsi**

8.What was the exclusive characteristics of traditional chanderi cloth? [U] / [CO2]

c). **light,sheer quality**

9.The Lambadi community traditionally used embroidery to decorate: [K] / [CO3]

c). **Their clothing like skirts and blouses**

10. What design is commonly found on the pallu of Ilkal saris? [K] / [CO2]

b). **Temple towers**

Part B

Fill in the Blanks

Answer all questions

Each question carries 1 marks

11. **Weaving** and **embroidery** are textile decoration techniques prevalent in traditional India. [U] / [CO1]

12. The Mising community's traditional shawl is called **Gaseng**. [U] / [CO3]

13.The technique of creation of Chikan work is known as **shadow work/ Chikankari** [U] / [CO2]

14.The time taken to weave a Jamdhani can take from a . **few weeks to a year** complete one saree.

[K] / [CO3]

15.**Kantha** and **pipli** are two embroidered textiles of Eastern India . [U] / [CO2]

16.The most common Balucharis have thread in **red or maroon** colours to weave the entire pattern.

17.Gota work is often used along with **Kinari (edging/border)**. [U] / [CO3]

18.The Paithani sari was worn by **royalty/noblewomen** in the olden days. [K] / [CO2]

19.Lambadi embroidery was traditionally used for decorating garments like phetia and kanchali, whereas Kasuti embroidery was predominantly used on **Ilkal saris / khanas..** [K] / [CO3]

20.The **Odisha/Andhra Pradesh/Gujarat** region practice the ikat like handwoven textiles in India.[U] / [CO2]

Part C

Answer in One Word or One Sentance

Answer all questions

Each question carries 1 marks

21.Which valley is famous for shawl weaving in Himachel Pradesh?

A. **Kullu is famous for its geometric-patterned woolen shawls.** [U] / [CO2]

22. Which court influenced the origins of Chamba embroidery?

A. **Persian Court**. [K] / [CO3]

23. What is Ryndia?

A. **Ryndia is the local Khasi name for Eri silk from Meghalaya.** [U] / [CO2]

24.Which motifs are commonly seen in Pipli work? [U] / [CO3]

A. **Pipli appliqué from Odisha uses bright mythological and nature motifs like elephants, peacocks, and lotus.**

25.Name the loom on which Benaras brocade were originally woven . [K] / [CO2]

A. **Traditional Banarasi brocades were woven on hand-operated pit looms**.

26.What are specialities of western Region Embroidery? [U] / [CO3]

A. **Subtle colours and intricate pattern**

Western Indian embroidery like Kutch, Kathiawar, and Rabari is known for mirrors, vibrant threads, and geometric patterns.

27. Which yarn appears on the design while weaving Himru textile? [K] / [CO2]

A. **Silk (base- cotton, design- silk)**

28. Write the tree based motif in the Parsi embroidery? [U] / [CO3]

A. **Weeping willow, cherry, pine, bamboo**

29.What weaving technique is used for the borders of Kasaragod sarees? [U] / [CO2]

A. **Jacquard**

30. What is the most distinctive feature of Mysore Silk Sarees' body design? [U] / [CO2]

A**. Minimalism/Plain body**

Mysore silk is known for a plain body with zari borders and pallu, emphasizing the lustre of pure silk.
[1x10 = 10]

Part D

Answer any 5 questions

Each question carries 2 marks

31. Distinguish between Kaudi bagh & Panchrang bagh. [K] / [CO3]

A. Baghs come under Phulkari of Punjab

- **Kaudi bagh**: Features small circular/coin-like motifs resembling cowrie shells (kaudi) arranged in neat rows.

- **Panchrang bagh**: Means 'five-color garden'. It has stylized floral/leaf motifs woven using five distinct colors in the border.

32. What is the significance of the Tangkhul Shawl? [U] / [CO2]

A. The Tangkhul shawl is a vital cultural marker of the Tangkhul Naga tribe in Manipur, symbolizing social status, marital, and martial achievements, with distinct types used for daily wear, rituals, and burials.

33. Explain how Kantha embroidery is created. [K] / [CO3]

A. Kantha from Bengal is made by layering 2–3 old sarees/dhotis. Artisans outline motifs of daily life, animals, and gods with running stitch. The entire surface is then filled with tiny, straight running stitches that quilt the layers and create a rippled texture. No knots are used.

34. Write the features of typical Maheshwari saree? [U] / [CO2]

A. 1. Material: Silk-cotton blend — silk warp, cotton weft — giving it a light, glossy finish.

2. Border & Pallu: Reversible borders with rui phool, chameli, and leher motifs. The pallu has 5 distinct stripes — 3 colored + 2 white.

3. Colors: Inspired by local elements like Narmada river, Maheshwar fort, an d temples. Maroon , Red, Gold, yellow, purple.

35. Differntiate chakla and Toran?

Chakla: [U] / [CO3]

- A. **Shape:** Primarily a **square** piece of fabric or beadwork.
- **Purpose & Usage:** Traditionally, a Chakda is a decorative wall hanging used to adorn the home, often featuring intricate motifs like peacocks, elephants, or Laxmi. Historically, it was also used to wrap dowry articles.
- **Key Features:** It often incorporates beads, glass, and mirror work

Toran

- **Shape:** A horizontal, elongated, or hanging item, often with tapering pennants.
- **Purpose & Usage:** A Toran (or Bandhanwar) is a decorative hanging specifically designed for the **doorway** or the top of a door frame to welcome guests and bring good luck.
- **Key Features:** Traditional Torans are made from flowers or mango leaves, while durable, decorative versions use fabric, beads, or metal to represent these auspicious elements.

36. What is the Korvai technique in weaving? [U] / [CO2]

A. Korvai is a three-shuttle technique used in Kanchipuram silk saris. The body and the contrast border/pallu are woven separately and interlocked at the joint using a specialized technique. This prevents colors from bleeding and allows bold, solid-colored borders against a different body color.

[2x5 = 10]

Part E

Long Answers

Answer any **2** questions

Each question carries **5** marks

37. List and describe three types of Naga shawls from different tribes. [U] / [CO2]

A. Naga shawls are identity markers showing tribe, status, and achievement.

1. Tangkhul Shawl (Haora): Worn by Tangkhul Nagas of Manipur. Base is usually black/red with broad white horizontal bands. The number of stripes and motifs indicates clan and marital status. Only warriors could wear certain shawls with specific patterns.

2. Ao Naga Shawl (Tsungkotepsu): Worn by Ao men of Nagaland. It's a warrior shawl, predominantly black with a thick red band in the middle. Animal motifs like elephant, tiger, and mithun head are woven to signify the wearer's hunting prowess and social rank.

3. Angami Shawl (Lohe): Worn by Angami Nagas. Features bold stripes of black, red, and yellow. The Mhoushü shawl is reserved for men who have performed feasts of merit, while Rhiko is for ordinary men.

38. Zardosi embroidery is considered as a symbol of royalty. Explain? [U] / [CO3]

A. Zardosi, meaning 'gold embroidery' in Persian, was patronized by Mughal royalty and later by Rajput and Deccan courts.

1. Material: It uses real gold and silver wires, called kalabattu, along with precious stones, sequins, and pearls. This made it extremely expensive and exclusive to kings, queens, and nobility.

2. Craftsmanship: The work is highly intricate and labor-intensive, done by specialized artisans called karigars. The 3D raised effect was achieved using silk threads padded under metallic wires.

3. Usage: It adorned royal costumes, court tents, wall hangings, and elephant/horse trappings. Even today, it's reserved for bridal and ceremonial wear, maintaining its association with luxury and high status.

39. Explain the weaving technique and composition of mashru textile. [U] / [CO2]

A. Mashru means 'permitted' in Arabic and was developed to comply with Islamic injunctions against wearing pure silk on the skin.

1. Weaving technique: It is a satin weave using a double-cloth structure. The warp is silk and the weft is cotton. The silk warp floats on the face, giving a glossy, luxurious appearance.

2. Composition: The face of the fabric is silk while the back that touches the skin is cotton. This made it acceptable for Muslim men to wear.

3. Features: Traditional Mashru from Gujarat has vibrant stripes or ikat patterns in bold colors like red, green, yellow. It was historically used for garments, turbans, and furnishings by royalty and traders.

40.Differentiate between the four main stitches used in Kasuti embroidery. [U] / [CO3]

A. Kasuti is a counted-thread embroidery from Karnataka done without knots. The four main stitches are:

Stitch Description Effect

Gavanti- Double running stitch worked in horizontal, vertical, and diagonal directions Creates straight lines and geometric patterns. Looks identical on both sides

Murgi- Resembles footsteps of a hen; a zig-zag running stitch Used to fill geometric motifs and appears as stepped lines

Negi- Ordinary running stitch worked in a darning pattern Used to create overall woven effect and fill large areas

Menthi- Cross stitch similar to Punjabi phulkari Used for filling motifs like flowers; done on a counted grid.

[5x2 = 10]\

Prepared by

Ms. Nimisha Devasia

Asst. Professor, YMBC,

Kothamangalam